

Preliminary Site Assessments — Staffordshire

Seven sites identified for initial survey. Assessments compiled from public records, satellite imagery, and advance reconnaissance. Analysis pending.

L1 — Agricultural Property, Rural Staffordshire

L1

PRELIMINARY ASSESSMENT

A small working farm approximately three miles from the nearest village in rural Staffordshire. The property consists of a farmhouse, outbuildings, and several cultivated fields. Land registry records confirm ownership by Arthur Dunn, age mid-50s, sole proprietor. The farmhouse is a two-story stone structure, early 20th century, showing signs of deferred maintenance. Post has been observed accumulating on the doorstep — uncollected for an estimated two weeks. The farmhouse appears unoccupied at present. Multiple fields are under cultivation; the north field shows visible crop distress — wheat appears grey and withered in patches, inconsistent with seasonal norms or known agricultural blights. The well water on the property has been reported (unconfirmed) to taste of salt — anomalous for an inland location approximately 100 miles from the nearest coast. Insect behavior in the vicinity is described by local sources as unusual — locusts have been observed stationary on fence posts, facing inward toward the field. Local temperature readings in the north field are reportedly elevated relative to surrounding areas. The property owner is currently unaccounted for — described by local residents as having departed for Scotland approximately two weeks ago, no contact since.

Accessibility: All shifts. Remote location — approximately 1 shift travel from Birmingham. No roadblocks or law enforcement presence at this time. The property is private land; access without owner permission may constitute trespass.

Assessment: Epicenter of anomalous environmental indicators. Crop distress, water quality, insect behavior, and temperature anomalies are inconsistent with known agricultural patterns. Owner's disappearance is noted. Source: satellite imagery, local interviews (unconfirmed), public records.

PRELIMINARY ASSESSMENT

A traditional English village pub located approximately three miles from the agricultural property under investigation. The building is a stone structure of apparent 18th or early 19th century construction — low ceilings, exposed wooden beams, fireplace. The establishment is licensed for alcohol service and operates as the de facto social hub for the surrounding rural community. The regular clientele consists of local farmers, retirees, and village residents. According to local sources, the missing farmer (Arthur Dunn) was a weekly Thursday regular at this establishment. His absence has been noted by the regulars. The publican has reportedly maintained a chalkboard betting pool regarding what the farmer may have discovered in his field — entries range from "Roman hoard" to "unexploded ordnance." The pot is approximately £47. The establishment's patrons are described by local sources as concerned about the missing farmer and willing to discuss the situation with outsiders who demonstrate genuine interest.

Accessibility: Day and Evening shifts. Open to the public — purchase of a beverage is customary but not mandatory. **Night:** closed. The publican may extend operating hours for patrons engaged in relevant conversation.

Assessment: Primary source of local testimony. The regulars' accounts — while anecdotal — may provide the most current information about the missing farmer's recent activities and discoveries. **Source:** public observation, local interviews (unconfirmed).

PRELIMINARY ASSESSMENT

A major regional museum in central Birmingham, housed in a Victorian-era building with columned façade and domed entrance. The museum's Anglo-Saxon collection occupies the east wing and includes the Staffordshire Hoard — approximately 3,500 pieces of gold, garnet, and silver recovered from a field near Lichfield in 1984. The hoard is displayed in climate-controlled glass cases arranged by artifact type. The collection is legally protected under UK heritage law. The museum maintains standard public hours (10 AM–5 PM daily) with security patrols during closed hours. The Anglo-Saxon gallery curator is Dr. Helen Price, a published academic with approximately 10 years at the institution. The museum's collection storage includes a climate-controlled vault beneath the gallery, accessible only to authorized staff via keycard and rotating access codes. Public access to the vault is not permitted. The museum's academic staff may be approached with scholarly inquiries.

Accessibility: Day shifts (public hours: 10 AM–5 PM). Evening/Night: closed to public, security patrols every 45 minutes. Staff may be accessible during business hours. Travel: local to Birmingham.

Assessment: Repository of potentially relevant archaeological material. The Staffordshire Hoard's proximity to the current site of interest is noted. Museum staff may provide academic context. **Source:** public records, museum publications.

PRELIMINARY ASSESSMENT

The United Kingdom's national library, located in central London. The manuscript reading room provides access to historical documents under supervised conditions — desks with individual lighting, climate-controlled environment, cotton-glove handling requirements for certain materials. Access requires a reader's card (available to researchers with appropriate credentials). The library's catalogue is publicly searchable online. Of potential relevance: the manuscript collection includes an 8th-century Mercian codex (vellum, approximately 40 folios) attributed to a monk identified as "Eadwine" of an unidentified abbey, containing a monastic chronicle with marginal annotations. The catalogue description notes the marginalia include "observations on local matters" beyond the main chronicle text. The manuscript has not been digitized and must be requested for physical examination. The library operates standard academic hours. Staff are described as professional and helpful. Photography restrictions apply to certain manuscripts.

Availability: Day shifts. Reading room hours: 9:30 AM–8 PM Mon–Thu, 9:30 AM–5 PM Fri–Sat. Reader's card required. Travel: approximately 2 shifts from Birmingham by rail.

Assessment: Potential source of historical context. The Mercian manuscript's marginalia may contain information relevant to the current area of investigation. Source: public library catalogue.

PRELIMINARY ASSESSMENT

The central archival repository of the Holy See, located within Vatican City, Rome. The archive holds documents spanning approximately two millennia of Church history. Public access is restricted — researchers must submit credentials, a research proposal, and a letter of recommendation from a recognized academic or ecclesiastical institution. The standard application backlog is approximately six weeks. The archive's catalogue is partially digitized. Of potential relevance: the archive is known to retain administrative records from the Roman administration of Britain, including provincial trade ledgers, military dispatches, and financial accounts. A preliminary catalogue search suggests one ledger — catalogued under "Roman Britain, Trade Records" — may reference financial transactions in the Staffordshire region during the 1st century CE. The ledger's content and relevance are unconfirmed without physical access. The archive employs specialist librarians, including at least one senior archivist with 22 years of service who may be able to expedite access for qualified researchers.

Availability: Day shifts only. Archive hours: 9 AM–1 PM, Mon–Sat. Access requires credentials and appointment. Standard backlog: 6 weeks. Expedited access may be possible through ecclesiastical or academic channels. Travel: international — requires flight to Rome.

Assessment: Potential source of historical records from the Roman period relevant to the current area of investigation. Access timeline is a significant operational constraint. Source: public archive catalogue (partial).

PRELIMINARY ASSESSMENT

A stone cottage in the Welsh countryside near Hay-on-Wye, a town known for its concentration of bookshops. The property is the private residence of Dr. Margaret Rhys, age 71, a retired archaeologist. Public records indicate Dr. Rhys was a member of the archaeological team that excavated the Staffordshire Hoard in 1984. Her specific role in the excavation and her current possession of dig records are unconfirmed but likely — retired archaeologists often retain personal copies of excavation documentation. Dr. Rhys is not known to have any connection to the current situation. Her academic publications and excavation experience may provide relevant context regarding the Staffordshire Hoard and its archaeological significance. The property is privately owned and occupied — access requires contact with the resident. Dr. Rhys is described by academic peers as approachable and willing to discuss her work with interested parties.

Availability: Day and Evening shifts. Private residence — approach with courtesy. Dr. Rhys is retired and typically present at the property. **Travel:** approximately 1 shift from Birmingham.

Assessment: Potential source of archaeological context and excavation documentation. No known connection to current situation. **Source:** public records, academic publications.

PRELIMINARY ASSESSMENT

A specific area within the north field of the agricultural property under investigation, identified by satellite thermal imaging as showing elevated soil temperature relative to surrounding terrain. The anomaly area is approximately 2 meters in diameter. Surface observation from distance indicates soil coloration darker than surrounding earth — nearly black in contrast to the typical brown-grey of Staffordshire topsoil. A small borehole — approximately 2 cm diameter, depth estimated at over 1 meter — has been observed at the center of the anomaly. The borehole's origin is unknown; it may be natural, animal-made, or the result of human activity (e.g., a soil probe or extraction). The area is in open farmland with no overhead cover. Ambient sound in the vicinity is reported as attenuated — normal environmental noise (birds, wind, distant traffic) is noticeably reduced within approximately 100 meters of the anomaly. This acoustic anomaly is unconfirmed and requires instrument verification. The field is privately owned farmland. Access without permission constitutes trespass under UK law.

Availability: All shifts. The field is open farmland — accessible on foot. The landowner (Arthur Dunn) is currently unaccounted for. Trespass laws apply. 1 shift travel from Birmingham. Exercise discretion — the area may attract official attention if environmental anomalies become publicly known.

Assessment: Physical epicenter of anomalous environmental indicators. The borehole and soil discoloration are inconsistent with natural agricultural conditions. Nature and cause of anomalies unknown. Source: satellite thermal imaging, distant observation, local reports (unconfirmed).